

# Diagonal Isoduality and Transversal Clifford Groups of MDS–CSS Codes

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## Abstract

Transversal gates implement encoded operations by tensor products of single-qudit unitaries. We determine the exact projective transversal logical group for the quantum MDS–CSS codes associated with linear  $[2m, m, m+1]_q$  maximum-distance-separable codes over odd prime fields, allowing the one-qudit gate to depend on the coordinate. The classification reduces to the diagonal multiplier space

$$\mathcal{D}(C, C^\perp) = \{s \in \mathbb{F}_q^{2m} : \text{diag}(s)C \subseteq C^\perp\}.$$

The MDS property forces this space to have dimension zero or one. The exact logical group is  $\mathbb{F}_q^2 \rtimes T$  in the zero-dimensional case and  $\mathbb{F}_q^2 \rtimes \text{SL}_2(q)$  in the one-dimensional case, where  $T$  is the split torus. Thus a linear-algebraic nullity test on the classical code determines all transversal logical unitaries. The construction is explicit, and an imported rigidity theorem for stabilizer absolutely maximally entangled states excludes non-Clifford product implementations.

For length six, the nonzero-multiplier condition is equivalent to the six projective points lying on a conic. We also classify an explicit non-GRS one-parameter family by a degree-eight invariant and analyze the Clebsch  $[6, 3, 4]_{11}$  code as an example. These six-point results and their exact certificate checks are applications of the all-length classification, not premises of it.

**Index Terms**—Absolutely maximally entangled states, Calderbank–Shor–Steane codes, conics, isodual codes, quantum MDS codes, self-association, six-arcs, transversal logical gates.

## 1 Introduction

A logical gate acts on encoded quantum information. A transversal implementation acts independently on the physical subsystems, so an error on one subsystem is not spread directly to another subsystem by the gate. This makes transversal gates a basic fault-tolerant primitive, but also a strongly constrained one: no quantum code admits a universal set of transversal gates [EK09]. Determining the exact transversal logical group of a code family is therefore a natural structural problem.

This paper solves that problem for a family of one-logical-qudit quantum MDS codes. Let  $C \leq \mathbb{F}_q^{2m}$  be a linear  $[2m, m, m+1]_q$  maximum-distance-separable (MDS) code. Its equal-phase CSS state is

$$|\Psi_C\rangle = q^{-m/2} \sum_{c \in C} |c\rangle. \quad (1.1)$$

The state is absolutely maximally entangled (AME). If one tensor factor is regarded as an input, the remaining factors define a  $[[2m-1, 1, m]]_q$  quantum MDS encoder.

Throughout, a *transversal* physical unitary has the fixed-coordinate, site-dependent form

$$U_1 \otimes \cdots \otimes U_{2m-1}.$$

The factors may differ from one coordinate to another. This convention is strictly broader than the uniform form  $U^{\otimes n}$ . The distinction is essential here: on one branch of the classification, a logical symplectic matrix is realized at different sites through conjugations determined by coordinatewise multiplier ratios. Logical groups are projective, so global scalar phases are divided out. Permutations of physical coordinates are not included unless stated explicitly.

The classification is controlled by a standard coding-theoretic object. A vector  $s \in \mathbb{F}_q^{2m}$  is a diagonal code-to-dual multiplier when  $\text{diag}(s)C \subseteq C^\perp$ . Write

$$\mathcal{D}(C, C^\perp) = \{s \in \mathbb{F}_q^{2m} : \text{diag}(s)C \subseteq C^\perp\}.$$

The MDS property makes this apparently large endomorphism problem rigid: the space has dimension zero or one, and any nonzero multiplier rescales every coordinate and maps  $C$  onto  $C^\perp$ . We call the latter case *diagonal isoduality*.

**Theorem 1.1** (Exact transversal logical group). Let  $q$  be an odd prime, let  $m \geq 2$ , and let  $C \leq \mathbb{F}_q^{2m}$  be a linear  $[2m, m, m+1]_q$  MDS code. Then  $\dim \mathcal{D}(C, C^\perp)$  is zero or one, and the projective group of logical unitaries with fixed-coordinate transversal implementations is

$$\begin{cases} \mathbb{F}_q^\times \rtimes T, & \dim \mathcal{D}(C, C^\perp) = 0, \\ \mathbb{F}_q^\times \rtimes \text{SL}_2(q), & \dim \mathcal{D}(C, C^\perp) = 1, \end{cases} \quad T = \{\text{diag}(a, a^{-1}) : a \in \mathbb{F}_q^\times\}.$$

The second case is equivalent to  $SC = C^\perp$  for a nonsingular diagonal matrix  $S$ .

Thus the exact transversal group is determined by one nullity computation on the classical code. The translation factor  $\mathbb{F}_q^\times$  consists of logical Paulis. The linear factor is either the split torus  $T$  or all of  $\text{SL}_2(q)$ ; no intermediate subgroup occurs.

The proof has three steps. First, represent each one-qudit Clifford by a 2-by-2 symplectic matrix. Preservation of the CSS stabilizer gives four block equations involving  $C$  and  $C^\perp$ . Any nonzero off-diagonal block is a diagonal multiplier from one code to the other. Second, the MDS distance forces every such multiplier to have full support and forces the multiplier space to be at most one-dimensional. If the space is zero, all local symplectic matrices are diagonal and the linear logical image is  $T$ . If it is one-dimensional, its generator constructs upper and lower unipotent matrices, which generate  $\text{SL}_2(q)$ . Finally, the imported rigidity theorem below shows that an arbitrary product-unitary implementation is Clifford at every site, proving that the constructed groups are exact.

The result fits into a broad study of transversal and automorphism-induced logical gates. Rains organizes coordinatewise symplectic symmetries through code-invariance algebras [Rai99, Theorems 4 and 14]. Compatible symplectic bases describe transversal Clifford structure for self-dual CSS codes [TTF25, Theorem 1], while uniform diagonal multiblock actions and endomorphism algebras constrain qubit stabilizer codes [DB25, Section II and Theorem 6.1]. Code automorphisms and ZX dualities give further Clifford constructions, including the Pauli corrections required to obtain the intended logical action [SKW<sup>+</sup>25, Sections III–IV]. Under the more restrictive uniform convention  $V_F^{\otimes n}$ , Prakash and Singhal characterize odd-prime one-logical-qudit codes with a complete transversal Clifford set [PS26, Section IV.C]; Albert gives related normal forms for binary CSS codes [Alb26, Sections III–V].

What is missing from these results is the exact fixed-coordinate, site-dependent group for the present MDS–CSS family. Theorem 1.1 supplies it by reducing the problem to  $\mathcal{D}(C, C^\perp)$ . The key MDS statement and both group constructions are proved here. We import only the following consequences of the companion paper: product-unitary rigidity, the encoder version of that rigidity, a stabilizer-character correction, and minimum-support transition data. Tan’s general AME–QMDS correspondence relates state symmetries and transversal encoder gates [Tan26, Theorems 3.5–3.6]; the present multiplier theorem computes the exact fixed-coordinate subgroup for this family.

**Theorem 1.2** (Imported stabilizer-AME rigidity [Rudd26a]). For every prime power  $q$  and  $m \geq 2$ , every product-unitary intertwiner between two stabilizer  $\text{AME}(2m, q)$  states is Clifford on each tensor factor.

**Corollary 1.3** (Imported transversal Clifford no-go [Rudd26a]). Every tensor-product conversion between the associated stabilizer  $[[2m-1, 1, m]]_q$  encoders is Clifford on every physical factor and on the logical factor. In particular, no code in this family admits a transversal non-Clifford logical unitary.

We also use one state-level consequence. A Clifford map of two stabilizer label groups need not preserve the chosen stabilizer characters, but a Pauli correction removes that discrepancy.

**Lemma 1.4** (Imported stabilizer-character correction [Rudd26a]). For stabilizer states in the standard finite-field Weyl convention, every product-Clifford map of their stabilizer label groups can be corrected by a product Pauli to map one state ray to the other.

The six-coordinate applications also use the companion paper’s minimum-support transition theorem. If  $L$  is the Pauli-label group of a stabilizer  $\text{AME}(2m, q)$  state, then the labels supported on any  $(m+1)$ -coordinate set project bijectively onto the Pauli-label plane at each retained coordinate, and these supported subgroups span  $L$ . Consequently, transition maps between overlapping supports determine local Clifford equivalence up to local trace-symplectic changes of basis. We use only this statement; its proof and the companion paper’s quantitative results are not repeated here.

The rest of the paper has two roles. First, it interprets the all-length criterion at six coordinates. A linear  $[6, 3, 4]_q$  MDS code is represented by six points in  $\mathbb{P}^2(\mathbb{F}_q)$ , no three collinear. In this model, diagonal isoduality means that the dual code is obtained by independently rescaling the six coordinates; projective geometers call the same condition fixed-label Gale self-association. For six points in the projective plane, it is equivalent to lying on a conic. An explicit non-GRS one-parameter family then has a degree-eight invariant  $z$  that classifies projective and monomial-code equivalence over odd fields and local-Clifford and local-unitary equivalence over odd prime fields. The Clebsch  $[6, 3, 4]_{11}$  code is a worked syndrome-geometric example.

Second, the paper records refinements and limitations of the classification. The linear  $\text{SL}_2(q)$  action has coherent Weil lifts, whereas the affine translation subgroup has the usual Heisenberg central extension. Coordinate permutations form a separate group-extension problem. Fixed-copy scalar contractions are generically constant on regular code families, while operator-valued reduced states retain the local Weyl directions used by the rigidity theorem. The finite six-point calculations have exact certificate replays, but no finite enumeration enters the all-length theorem.

Section 2 fixes the stabilizer and MDS–CSS conventions. Section 3 proves the multiplier theorem and exact group, then treats the lift refinements. Section 4 translates the criterion into six-point geometry. Section 5 classifies the one-parameter family, and Section 6 gives the limitation on fixed-copy scalar invariants. The appendices contain the explicit scalar separators, transport calculation, and coordinate-permutation extensions. Section 7 states the computational and formal trust boundaries.

## 2 Stabilizer AME states and MDS–CSS models

Let  $q = p^e$  and fix the additive character  $\chi(a) = \exp(2\pi i \text{Tr}_{\mathbb{F}_q/\mathbb{F}_p}(a)/p)$ . On the standard basis of  $\mathbb{C}^q$ , indexed by  $\mathbb{F}_q$ , put

$$X(a)|x\rangle = |x+a\rangle, \quad Z(b)|x\rangle = \chi(bx)|x\rangle.$$

For  $v = (a, b) \in \mathbb{F}_q^2$ , write  $W_v = X(a)Z(b)$ , with any fixed consistent phase convention when only its projective axis is used. The  $q^2$  single-party operators  $W_v$  form an orthogonal basis of the single-party Hilbert–Schmidt space. A unitary is Clifford when conjugation permutes their projective axes  $\mathbb{C}W_v$ .

After choosing dual  $\mathbb{F}_p$ -bases of  $\mathbb{F}_q$ , this Weyl system is the Pauli system of  $e$   $p$ -level factors. Its projective Clifford normalizer has the standard exact sequence

$$1 \longrightarrow \mathbb{F}_p^{2e} \longrightarrow \text{PCliff}(q) \longrightarrow \text{Sp}_{2e}(\mathbb{F}_p) \longrightarrow 1. \quad (2.1)$$

including  $p = 2$ : the kernel is the projective Pauli group, and every trace-symplectic  $\mathbb{F}_p$ -linear label map has a Clifford lift [DDM03, HDDM05].

For  $n$  parties, a pure stabilizer state is fixed by an abelian Pauli group  $\mathcal{S}$  of order  $q^n$ . Its projective label group  $L \leq (\mathbb{F}_q^2)^n$ , viewed additively over  $\mathbb{F}_p$ , is maximal isotropic for the trace-symplectic form. This is the standard arbitrary-additive prime-power stabilizer correspondence [KKKS06, Theorems 13 and 15]. For each  $\ell \in L$ , write the stabilizer lift as  $\widetilde{W}_\ell = \alpha_\ell W_\ell$ , where  $\alpha_\ell \neq 0$ . Then

$$|\psi\rangle\langle\psi| = q^{-n} \sum_{\ell \in L} \widetilde{W}_\ell. \quad (2.2)$$

If  $A$  is a party set, put

$$L(A) = \{\ell \in L : \text{supp}(\ell) \subseteq A\}.$$

Weyl orthogonality and partial trace give

$$\rho_A^\psi = q^{-|A|} \sum_{\ell \in L(A)} \widetilde{W}_\ell. \quad (2.3)$$

In particular,  $\rho_A^\psi$  is maximally mixed exactly when  $L(A) = \{0\}$ . Thus a stabilizer state on  $2m$  parties is AME exactly when it has no nonidentity stabilizer label supported on at most  $m$  parties.

The rigidity and minimum-support transition theorems use only (2.1)–(2.3). For the geometric classification and explicit six-party applications, we now specialize to the MDS–CSS model.

A six-arc is an ordered sextuple of points of  $\mathbb{P}^2(\mathbb{F}_q)$  with no three collinear. Choose nonzero column representatives and collect them in a 3-by-6 matrix  $H$ . The arc condition says that every three-column minor of  $H$  is nonzero. Consequently

$$C = \ker H \leq \mathbb{F}_q^6$$

is an  $[6, 3, 4]_q$  MDS code, and its dual  $C^\perp = \text{rowspan } H$  is MDS with the same parameters. Conversely, a parity-check matrix of such a code supplies a six-arc. Projectivities, independent rescaling of columns, and permutation of columns correspond exactly to monomial equivalences of the kernels. These objects exist exactly when  $q \geq 4$ . Indeed, from one point of a six-arc the five joining lines are distinct, so  $q + 1 \geq 5$ . For  $q = 4$ , a conic together with its nucleus is a six-arc; for  $q \geq 5$ , any six points of a nonsingular conic form a six-arc.

For the resulting CSS stabilizer we use the exact lift

$$W_{(c,h)} = X(c)Z(h) = \bigotimes_{i=1}^6 X(c_i)Z(h_i), \quad (c, h) \in C \oplus C^\perp.$$

Since  $h \cdot c' = 0$  for  $h \in C^\perp$  and  $c' \in C$ , these lifts multiply without a residual phase and fix  $|\Psi_C\rangle$ .

**Proposition 2.1** (Arc–AME dictionary). For a six-arc with kernel  $C$ , the state  $|\Psi_C\rangle$  in (1.1) is a minimal-support stabilizer  $\text{AME}(6, q)$  state. Its projective Pauli-label Lagrangian is

$$L_C = (C \oplus 0) + (0 \oplus C^\perp) \leq \mathbb{F}_q^{12}.$$

Conversely, for a linear  $[6, 3]_q$  code  $C$  the state  $|\Psi_C\rangle$  is  $\text{AME}(6, q)$  only if  $C$  has minimum distance four, so the dictionary is an equivalence. Monomial code equivalence, together with a party permutation, induces local-Clifford equivalence of the corresponding states.

*Proof.* The operators  $X(c)$ ,  $c \in C$ , fix the equal superposition. The operators  $Z(h)$ ,  $h \in C^\perp$ , fix it because  $\chi(h \cdot c) = 1$ . The two subgroups commute, and their label space has dimension six and is Lagrangian.

For any three-coordinate set  $I$ , puncturing  $C$  to  $I$  is bijective: injectivity follows from distance four and both spaces have dimension three. In the partial trace of  $|\Psi_C\rangle\langle\Psi_C|$ , equality on the complementary three coordinates therefore forces equality of the codewords, while the projection to  $I$  runs once through  $\mathbb{F}_q^3$ . Hence every three-party reduction is  $q^{-3}I$ . Smaller reductions are maximally mixed by tracing again, so the state is  $\text{AME}(6, q)$ . Its support has the minimum possible size  $q^3$ .

For the converse, suppose the linear  $[6, 3]_q$  code  $C$  has a nonzero word  $c$  of weight at most three, and choose a three-party set  $A$  containing its support. Then  $(c, 0)$  is a nonidentity label of  $L_C$  supported on  $A$ , so  $L_C(A) \neq \{0\}$  and  $\rho_A$  is not maximally mixed. Hence an AME equal-phase state forces minimum distance four, which at length six and dimension three is the exact  $[6, 3, 4]_q$  parameter set.

A column multiplier  $x \mapsto ax$  is a single-party Clifford operation: it sends  $X(b)$  to  $X(ab)$  and  $Z(b)$  to  $Z(a^{-1}b)$ . Projective row operations do not change the kernel, and column permutations permute parties. This proves the last assertion.  $\square$

For a party set  $S$ , let

$$L_C(S) = \{\ell \in L_C : \text{supp}(\ell) \subseteq S\}.$$

The general stabilizer partial-trace formula specializes to

$$\rho_S^C = q^{-|S|} \sum_{\ell \in L_C(S)} W_\ell. \quad (2.4)$$

For later block calculations, write

$$C_X = C \oplus 0, \quad C_Z^\perp = 0 \oplus C^\perp, \quad L_C = C_X \oplus C_Z^\perp.$$

This formula is the bridge used in both the rigidity proof and the marginal invariants below. A Pauli-labelled quantity is not by itself an LU invariant; the invariant statements will always be expressed either as covariance of the reduced operators or as basis-free tensor contractions.

The GRS boundary has a simple geometric meaning. A dimension-three length-six generalized Reed–Solomon code is represented, up to column multipliers, by six points on a nonsingular conic in  $\mathbb{P}^2$ . We use “GRS state” for the state of any such code. The non-GRS pencil in Section 5 consists of arc matrices  $H_t$  away from that conic locus and from the other factors needed to keep the columns distinct and the displayed coordinates defined.

### 3 Exact MDS–CSS logical images and lifts

The classification rests on one MDS rigidity statement. It converts every nonzero coordinate-wise map between two half-dimensional MDS codes into an isomorphism and leaves room for at most one projective multiplier.

**Proposition 3.1** (The diagonal-multiplier line). Let  $E, F \leq \mathbb{F}_q^{2m}$  be linear  $[2m, m, m+1]_q$  MDS codes, and put

$$\mathcal{D}(E, F) = \{s \in \mathbb{F}_q^{2m} : \text{diag}(s)E \subseteq F\}.$$

Every nonzero  $s \in \mathcal{D}(E, F)$  has full coordinate support and  $\text{diag}(s)E = F$ . Consequently

$$\dim_{\mathbb{F}_q} \mathcal{D}(E, F) \leq 1, \quad \mathcal{D}(E, E) = \mathbb{F}_q(1, \dots, 1).$$

In particular,  $\mathcal{D}(C, C^\perp)$  has dimension zero or one, and  $C$  is diagonally isodual exactly in the dimension-one case. When that line exists, any two nonzero witnesses differ by a unique nonzero scalar, so every ratio  $s_i/s_j$  is intrinsic.

*Proof.* Let  $s \neq 0$ , and write  $D = \text{diag}(s)$ . If  $D$  had support of size at most  $m$ , choose a word of  $E$  nonzero at a supported coordinate. Its image would be a nonzero word of  $F$  of weight at most  $m$ , contrary to the distance of  $F$ . Thus  $D$  has at least  $m+1$  nonzero entries. Its kernel on  $E$  consists of words supported on at most  $m-1$  coordinates, so the distance of  $E$  makes that kernel zero. Equal dimensions now give  $DE = F$ . A zero diagonal entry would force every word of  $F$  to vanish at that coordinate, which an MDS code does not, so  $s$  has full support.

If two multipliers were independent, a nonzero linear combination could be chosen to vanish at one coordinate, contradicting full support. Hence  $\dim \mathcal{D}(E, F) \leq 1$ . The all-ones vector belongs to  $\mathcal{D}(E, E)$ , proving the self-multiplier statement. Taking  $F = C^\perp$  gives the remaining assertions.  $\square$

Thus the diagonal-isoduality test has only two outcomes: no multiplier, or a unique multiplier line generated by a full-support vector.

*Proof of Theorem 1.1.* Write a fixed-coordinate product-Clifford action on Pauli labels as

$$F_i = \begin{pmatrix} \alpha_i & \beta_i \\ \gamma_i & \delta_i \end{pmatrix},$$

and let  $D_\alpha, D_\beta, D_\gamma, D_\delta$  be the diagonal matrices with the corresponding entries. Preservation of  $L_C = C_X \oplus C_Z^\perp$  is equivalent to

$$\begin{aligned} D_\alpha C &\subseteq C, & D_\gamma C &\subseteq C^\perp, \\ D_\beta C^\perp &\subseteq C, & D_\delta C^\perp &\subseteq C^\perp. \end{aligned} \tag{3.1}$$

*Non-isodual case.* If any coordinate block is nondiagonal, then  $D_\beta$  or  $D_\gamma$  is nonzero. Proposition 3.1 and (3.1) give

$$D_\gamma C = C^\perp \quad \text{or} \quad D_\beta C^\perp = C.$$

The second equality can be inverted, so either one supplies a nonsingular diagonal  $S$  with  $SC = C^\perp$ . Consequently, on the non-isodual branch every coordinate block is diagonal. Equation (3.1) then gives  $D_\alpha C \subseteq C$  and  $D_\delta C^\perp \subseteq C^\perp$ . Applying Proposition 3.1 with  $E = F = C$ , and then with  $E = F = C^\perp$ , gives  $D_\alpha = aI$  and  $D_\delta = dI$ . The local determinant condition gives  $ad = 1$ . Thus every coordinate block is the same  $\text{diag}(a, a^{-1})$ ; these blocks always preserve  $L_C$ , so the exact linear factor is  $T$ . Logical Paulis have physical Pauli representatives, so this branch gives  $\mathbb{F}_q^2 \rtimes T$ .

*Isodual case.* Now suppose

$$S = \text{diag}(s_1, \dots, s_{2m}), \quad SC = C^\perp. \tag{3.2}$$

The projective vector  $[s_1 : \dots : s_{2m}]$ , and hence every propagation ratio  $s_i/s_j$ , depends only on  $C$ .

For  $\lambda, \mu \in \mathbb{F}_q$ , put

$$F_i^-(\lambda) = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ \lambda s_i & 1 \end{pmatrix}, \quad F_i^+(\mu) = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & \mu s_i^{-1} \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}. \quad (3.3)$$

On the CSS label space  $L_C = (C \oplus 0) + (0 \oplus C^\perp)$ , the product of the lower blocks sends

$$(c, h) \mapsto (c, h + \lambda S c),$$

and the product of the upper blocks sends

$$(c, h) \mapsto (c + \mu S^{-1} h, h).$$

Thus both products preserve  $L_C$  and lift to product-Clifford tensor symmetries: Lemma 1.4 supplies the required product-Pauli corrections. Thus label-space preservation is sufficient here; no coherent choice of Clifford phases is being assumed. At any chosen input party  $j$ , their blocks run through all lower and upper elementary unipotents because  $s_j \neq 0$ . Together these generate  $\mathrm{SL}_2(q)$ . Under the Choi correspondence, an input block  $A$  induces the logical block  $A^{-T}$ . This map is an automorphism of  $\mathrm{SL}_2(q)$ , so every one-qudit logical symplectic action has a product-Clifford physical implementation. Logical Paulis have physical Pauli representatives, so the full projective one-qudit Clifford group  $\mathbb{F}_q^2 \rtimes \mathrm{SL}_2(q)$  is transversal.

*Exactness.* The imported Corollary 1.3 excludes every product-unitary logical action outside that group. Hence the displayed group is exact.  $\square$

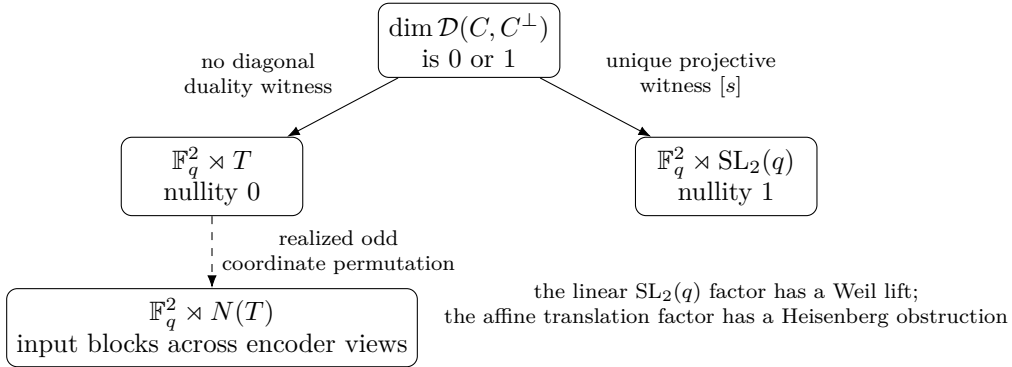


Figure 1: The nullity of the diagonal multiplier space selects the exact fixed-coordinate projective transversal group. Coordinate permutations form a separate extension problem: in the computed non-GRS rows, an odd permutation enlarges the possible input blocks from  $T$  to  $N(T)$  across encoder views, but it need not fix the chosen encoder input.

For a generalized or extended generalized Reed–Solomon code, the standard dual formula supplies (3.2), including the extended evaluation point at length  $q + 1$  [HP03, Sections 5.2–5.3]. Thus the GRS tower lies on the diagonally isodual branch, although the proof uses no evaluation structure.

### 3.1 Site-dependent propagation

The classification allows different one-qudit Clifford factors at different coordinates. We now ask when local changes of Clifford frame can make the physical implementation uniform.

There are two different lift questions behind this projective statement. Fix an input coordinate  $j$ , put  $t_i = s_i/s_j$ , and write

$$A = \begin{pmatrix} a & b \\ c & d \end{pmatrix} \in \mathrm{SL}_2(q).$$

Propagation to coordinate  $i$  is

$$\phi_i(A) = \begin{pmatrix} a & t_i^{-1}b \\ t_i c & d \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & t_i \end{pmatrix} A \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & t_i^{-1} \end{pmatrix}. \quad (3.4)$$

Thus every  $\phi_i$  is a homomorphism,  $\phi_j$  is the identity, and the elementary matrices in (3.3) satisfy all  $\mathrm{SL}_2(q)$  relations coordinatewise. This calculation also applies at the extended evaluation point. It uses only the diagonal duality  $SC = C^\perp$ , not the evaluation formula for a GRS code. Conjugation by  $\mathrm{diag}(1, t_i)$  is inner on  $\mathrm{SL}_2(q)$  exactly when  $t_i$  is a square: the centralizer of  $\mathrm{SL}_2(q)$  in  $\mathrm{GL}_2(q)$  is scalar, and a scalar multiple of this diagonal matrix has determinant one exactly in the square case. Since  $t_j = 1$ , if some  $t_i$  is nonsquare then the propagated action cannot be made uniform by fixed local Clifford frame changes; its  $i$ -th factor represents the diagonal outer automorphism.

### 3.2 Coherent lifts and the affine obstruction

For the present odd prime  $q$ , and more generally for any odd prime power, the finite Stone–von Neumann representation of the Heisenberg group  $H_q$  extends to a genuine representation of  $\mathrm{SL}_2(q) \ltimes H_q$  [Gér76, Theorem 1]. Apply its Weil factor to each  $\phi_i(A)$ . The resulting tensor product is multiplicative in  $A$ . In the symmetric Weyl convention  $D_{a,b} = \chi(ab/2)X(a)Z(b)$ , a CSS label  $(c, h) \in C \oplus C^\perp$  has tensor lift

$$\bigotimes_i D_{c_i, h_i} = \chi(c \cdot h/2)X(c)Z(h) = X(c)Z(h),$$

because  $c \cdot h = 0$ . Exact Egorov covariance therefore preserves the CSS stabilizer group with its trivial character, and hence the state ray, rather than only its projective label space. Consequently the one-qudit Clifford scalar extension, restricted to the linear  $\mathrm{SL}_2(q)$  factor, splits coherently with the propagated tensor symmetries. The exceptional uniqueness clause at  $q = 3$  in Gérardin’s theorem does not remove existence.

The affine extension does not split. Choose  $a, b \in \mathbb{F}_q$  with  $\chi(ab) \neq 1$ , and put  $X = X(a)$ ,  $Z = Z(b)$ . Their projective classes commute, whereas every choice of unitary representatives satisfies

$$ZX = \chi(ab)XZ, \quad \chi(ab) \neq 1.$$

Scalar changes of  $X$  and  $Z$  do not change their commutator. Hence the translation subgroup  $\mathbb{F}_q^2$  has no homomorphic lift to the one-qudit unitary Clifford group. The coherent lift above is therefore  $H_q \rtimes \mathrm{SL}_2(q)$ , not a section of  $\mathbb{F}_q^2 \rtimes \mathrm{SL}_2(q)$  through the scalar quotient. This is the Heisenberg central extension, not a residual metaplectic or Schur-multiplier obstruction on  $\mathrm{SL}_2(q)$ .

*Remark 3.2* (Coordinate permutations). Neither lift question decides what happens when physical coordinates may be permuted. That is a separate extension of the fixed-coordinate projective group by the realized coordinate-permutation group. Appendix C states its splitting criterion and gives computed examples.

## 4 The six-point conic criterion and the Clebsch example

Section 3 already determines the fixed-coordinate transversal logical group at every length. In the six-coordinate case, the same coding-theoretic test has a classical geometric interpretation: a diagonal multiplier from  $C$  to  $C^\perp$  exists exactly when the six projective points lie on a conic.

Throughout this section  $q$  is an odd prime. Regard any one party of an  $\mathrm{AME}(6, q)$  stabilizer tensor as an input and the other five as outputs. This is a  $[[5, 1, 3]]_q$  encoding isometry. In



prime local dimension, the symplectic action of a one-qudit Clifford is a block in  $\mathrm{SL}_2(q)$ , so the kernel of the party action on Clifford tensor symmetries is

$$\mathcal{K}_C = \{(F_1, \dots, F_6) \in \mathrm{SL}_2(q)^6 : (\bigoplus_i F_i)L_C = L_C\}.$$

For  $q = p^e$  with  $e > 1$ , the full local Clifford group acts instead through  $\mathrm{Sp}_{2e}(\mathbb{F}_p)$ ; the displayed field-linear block group is then not the full local Clifford kernel. For an encoder view, the *fixed-coordinate logical symplectic image* means the image of  $\mathcal{K}_C$  on its input block. Theorem 1.1 identifies the all-length dichotomy by diagonal isoduality. Geometrically, the same condition is called fixed-label Gale self-association: the labeled six-point configuration is projectively equivalent to its Gale transform without permuting the labels. The next lemma identifies this condition with the conic locus.

**Lemma 4.1** (Fixed-label self-association). Let  $H$  be a rank-three  $3 \times 6$  matrix whose columns are a six-arc, and put  $C = \ker H$ . There is a nonsingular diagonal matrix  $S$  with  $SC = C^\perp$  if and only if the six columns of  $H$  lie on a conic.

*Proof.* Let  $G$  be a  $3 \times 6$  generator matrix for  $C$ . Its columns are the labeled Gale transform of the columns of  $H$ . Since  $C^\perp = \mathrm{row}(H)$ ,

$$SC = C^\perp \iff \mathrm{row}(GS) = \mathrm{row}(H) \iff AGS = H \text{ for some } A \in \mathrm{GL}_3(q).$$

Thus the condition is precisely fixed-label projective equivalence to the Gale transform. This fixed locus can be identified directly over the finite field. Put

$$V_i = (x_i^2, y_i^2, z_i^2, x_i y_i, x_i z_i, y_i z_i)$$

and let  $V$  be the 6-by-6 matrix with rows  $V_i$ . The six entries are the degree-two monomials in three variables, equivalently the independent coefficients of a symmetric 3-by-3 matrix. Thus a vector in the kernel of  $V$  is a quadratic form vanishing on all six points, and  $\det V = 0$  is exactly the conic condition. Every five rows of  $V$  are independent: a relation supported on at most five points would give  $H_I D H_I^T = 0$  for a nonsingular diagonal  $D$  on its support  $I$ ; for  $|I| \geq 3$ , this would put the three-dimensional row space of  $H_I D$  inside  $\ker H_I$ , which has dimension at most two, while smaller supports are immediate. Hence any relation  $\sum_i d_i V_i = 0$  has every  $d_i \neq 0$ .

Writing  $D = \mathrm{diag}(d_i)$ , that relation is  $HDH^T = 0$ . Therefore  $\mathrm{row}(HD) \subseteq \ker H = C$ , and equality follows from dimension three. Thus  $CD^{-1} = C^\perp$ . Conversely, a nonsingular diagonal equivalence  $SC = C^\perp$  gives  $HS^{-1}H^T = 0$ , hence a relation among the rows of  $V$  and a conic through the six columns. The conic is irreducible because the columns form an arc. This is the finite-field fixed-label form of the classical six-point self-association theorem [HMSV08, Section 2.3].  $\square$

**Theorem 4.2** (Six-point transversal-group criterion). For an equal-phase CSS state from a six-arc over an odd prime field, the fixed-coordinate logical symplectic image is

$$\begin{cases} \mathrm{SL}_2(q), & \text{if the arc is conic/GRS,} \\ T = \{\mathrm{diag}(a, a^{-1}) : a \in \mathbb{F}_q^\times\}, & \text{if the arc is nonconic.} \end{cases} \quad (4.1)$$

Thus every encoder view of a GRS tensor realizes the full one-qudit logical symplectic group from fixed-coordinate symmetries. Off the GRS locus, the fixed-coordinate logical symplectic image is the split torus. At a chosen input coordinate, any coordinate-permuting isoduality that exchanges the CSS  $X$ - and  $Z$ -spaces transports the encoder view by the nontrivial Weyl-group element, so the possible input blocks generate the normalizer of  $T$  together with  $T$ . This is an action on one fixed encoder only when the isoduality fixes its input leg.

*Proof.* Theorem 1.1 gives  $\text{SL}_2(q)$  exactly on the diagonally isodual branch and  $T$  otherwise. Lemma 4.1 identifies diagonal isoduality with the conic locus. At a chosen input coordinate, a coordinate-permuting isoduality exchanges the CSS  $X$ - and  $Z$ -axes and hence represents the nontrivial Weyl-group element normalizing  $T$ . It acts on one fixed encoder only when the coordinate permutation fixes that encoder's input.  $\square$

Adding logical Paulis recovers the exact fixed-coordinate projective logical groups in Theorem 1.1.

This is an operational distinction, not a classical automorphism count. The fixed-party non-GRS group has order  $q^2(q-1)$ , while the GRS group has order  $q^2|\text{SL}_2(q)|$ .

**Lemma 4.3** (Coset states and three-party syndrome charts). Let  $H$  be a rank-three parity-check matrix whose six columns form an arc, put  $C = \ker H$ , and set

$$|\Psi_e\rangle = X(e)|\Psi_C\rangle, \quad |\Psi_C\rangle = q^{-3/2} \sum_{c \in C} |c\rangle.$$

Then  $|\Psi_e\rangle = |\Psi_f\rangle$  if and only if  $e - f \in C$ , and states from distinct cosets are orthogonal. In the row basis of  $H$ , the  $Z(C^\perp)$ -stabilizer syndrome of  $|\Psi_e\rangle$  is  $He^\top$ . Consequently the least support of an  $X$ -operator producing  $|\Psi_e\rangle$  is the minimum Hamming weight in  $e + C$ .

For every syndrome  $s \in \mathbb{F}_q^3$  and every three-party set  $I$ , there is a unique representative  $e$  supported in  $I$  with  $He^\top = s$ . If the coset with syndrome  $s$  has minimum weight three, this representative has support exactly  $I$ .

*Proof.* Translation replaces the computational support  $C$  by the affine coset  $e + C$ . Two such supports are equal precisely when  $e - f \in C$ ; otherwise they are disjoint, which also proves orthogonality. If  $h$  is a row of  $H$ , then  $h \in C^\perp$ , and  $Z(h)$  acts on the entire coset  $e + C$  by the character  $\chi(h \cdot e)$ . Reading this for the three rows of  $H$  gives  $He^\top$ .

Now fix  $I$ . The arc condition says exactly that the three columns in  $I$  form an invertible matrix  $H_I$ . Thus  $H_I e_I^\top = s$  has one solution, and extension by zero gives the unique representative supported in  $I$ . If one of its three coordinates vanished, the same syndrome would have a representative of weight at most two. A minimum weight-three syndrome therefore uses all three coordinates.  $\square$

The Clebsch example also belongs to the pencil studied in Section 5: over  $\mathbb{F}_{11}$ , the parameter  $t = 2$  has  $z = 1$  and gives the Clebsch/ $H_3$  class. Its syndrome geometry illustrates why a conic in the error-syndrome space must not be confused with the conic criterion for the six parity-check columns.

**Proposition 4.4** (Clebsch extremal  $X$ -syndrome conic). Let  $H$  be a parity-check matrix whose columns are the Clebsch six-arc in  $\mathbb{P}^2(\mathbb{F}_{11})$ , put  $C = \ker H$ , and write

$$|\Psi_e\rangle = X(e)|\Psi_C\rangle, \quad |\Psi_C\rangle = 11^{-3/2} \sum_{c \in C} |c\rangle.$$

The syndromes whose cosets have minimum  $X$ -support three are the 120 nonzero vectors on twelve projective rays forming a nonsingular conic in  $\mathbb{P}^2(\mathbb{F}_{11})$ . Each such syndrome has exactly one weight-three representative on each of the  $\binom{6}{3} = 20$  three-party supports. The monomial automorphism group  $C_{10} \times A_5$  is transitive on the 120 syndromes:  $A_5$  is transitive on the twelve rays with point stabilizer  $C_5$ , and  $C_{10}$  is transitive on the ten nonzero vectors of each ray. Nevertheless, the defining six-arc is nonconic, so the fixed-party logical symplectic image of every encoder view is the split torus  $T$ , not  $\text{SL}_2(11)$ .

*Proof.* Lemma 4.3 identifies minimum  $X$ -support with coset-leader weight and gives one representative on every three-party support. The Clebsch deep-hole theorem identifies the covering radius as three and the twelve projective maximum-distance syndromes with a nonsingular conic; it also gives the transitive  $C_{10} \times A_5$  action [Rudd26b, Proposition 6.2, Corollary 6.3, and Proposition 6.4]. Finally, the Clebsch arc is non-GRS and hence nonconic. The last assertion is therefore Theorem 4.2 at  $q = 11$ .  $\square$

*Remark 4.5 (Error symmetry without fixed-party duality). Syndrome geometry versus code geometry.* The one-per-support statement means that the same extremal translated state can be created by a minimum  $X$ -operator on either side of every balanced  $3 \mid 3$  cut. The conic belongs to the  $X$ -error syndrome plane; it does not put the six parity-check columns on a conic. Thus the extremal  $X$ -error shell has icosahedral covariance while the fixed-party transversal group has no Fourier block exchanging  $X$  and  $Z$ . This is a fixed-party statement, not an obstruction to every electric–magnetic exchange.

*Coordinate-permutation bookkeeping.* In the computed Clebsch row of Corollary C.1, the factor  $C_{10}$  scales the ten nonzero syndrome vectors on each ray and disappears after projectivization. The remaining  $A_5$  is the projective monomial quotient, whereas  $S_5$  is the larger realized party image. Odd party motion inverts  $T$  and supplies the nontrivial class of  $N(T)/T$ .

Changing the row basis of  $H$  changes the displayed conic by a projective coordinate transformation. The covering radius here concerns only generalized- $X$  translates of the six-leg AME state; it is not a claim that the associated  $[[5, 1, 3]]_{11}$  output code corrects arbitrary weight-three errors. The unlabelled conic also carries neither a chosen coordinate six-set nor the support orientation used by finer Clebsch constructions. Theorem 1.2 supplies the separate exact rigidity statement: every product-unitary intertwiner from this tensor to a stabilizer AME tensor is Clifford factor by factor.

A different MDS uniformity governs operator pushing. Fix an input party and a nonidentity Pauli label. Each of the ten four-sets containing that party carries a unique stabilizer representative with that support; removing the input leaves a weight-three output Pauli. Thus a fixed input Pauli has ten minimum-support pushes. Lemma 4.3 instead fixes an  $X$ -syndrome and varies over all twenty three-party supports. Neither count uses the finite group calculation, although the symmetry orbits of the operator pushes can distinguish finer projective classes. The comparison separates two uses of MDS uniformity: one fixes an input Pauli and counts its minimum-weight physical representatives, while the other fixes an  $X$ -syndrome and varies the support of a translating operator.

## 5 The non-GRS pencil and its quotient

We now study a one-parameter family of six-point MDS codes for which the projective equivalence problem can be solved explicitly. The family contains the Clebsch example over  $\mathbb{F}_{11}$ , meets the conic/GRS locus in a visible divisor, and retains nontrivial projective variation away from that divisor. It therefore gives a concrete test of how the all-length group theorem interacts with six-point geometry.

Over a finite field of odd order, put

$$H_t = ((0, 1, 1 - t), (0, 1, t - 1), (1, 1 - t, 0), (1, t - 1, 0), (1, 0, -t), (1, 0, t)),$$

and define

$$A(t) = -4t(t - 1)^2, \quad B(t) = (t^2 - t + 1)(t^2 - 3t + 1), \quad z(t) = (B(t)/A(t))^2.$$

The form of  $z$  is dictated by the residual parameter symmetries. The intermediate coordinate

$$y(t) = \frac{(t-1)^2}{t}$$

is generically two-to-one in  $t$ , and projective equivalence identifies  $y$  with  $\pm y^{\pm 1}$ . The function  $z = (y - y^{-1})^2/16$  is invariant under these four transformations, so the map  $t \mapsto z$  is generically eight-to-one. The proof below shows that these are all projective identifications.

Also put

$$G(t) = t^4 - 4t^3 + 7t^2 - 4t + 1.$$

The factors have two distinct roles. The conditions  $t(t-1)(t^2-t+1)(t^2-3t+1) \neq 0$  keep the six columns in arc position and make the displayed quotient coordinates nonzero and defined. The remaining condition  $G(t) \neq 0$  removes the conic, equivalently GRS, locus. Define the regular non-GRS parameter set

$$\mathcal{U} = \{t : t(t-1)(t^2-t+1)(t^2-3t+1)G(t) \neq 0\}. \quad (5.1)$$

Indeed, factoring the twenty 3-by-3 column minors gives the first four factors, while the determinant for a conic through the six columns is a unit times  $G$ . For  $t \in \mathcal{U}$ , write  $C_t = \ker H_t$  and  $\Psi_t = \Psi_{C_t}$ .

**Theorem 5.1** (Projective and Clifford quotient). For  $t, u \in \mathcal{U}$ , the following are equivalent:

$$H_t \sim_{\text{proj}} H_u, \quad C_t \sim_{\text{mon}} C_u, \quad z(t) = z(u),$$

allowing arbitrary party permutations. If  $q$  is prime, these are also equivalent to  $\Psi_t \sim_{\text{LC}} \Psi_u$ .

**Corollary 5.2** (Quantum classification on the regular locus). If  $q$  is an odd prime and  $t, u \in \mathcal{U}$ , then

$$H_t \sim_{\text{proj}} H_u \iff C_t \sim_{\text{mon}} C_u \iff \Psi_t \sim_{\text{LC}} \Psi_u \iff \Psi_t \sim_{\text{LU}} \Psi_u \iff z(t) = z(u),$$

where every equivalence allows a party permutation.

*Proof. Projective quotient.* Then  $A = -4t^2y$ ,  $B = t^2(y^2 - 1)$ , and

$$z = \frac{(y - y^{-1})^2}{16}.$$

It follows that  $z(t) = z(u)$  exactly when

$$y(u) \in \{y(t), -y(t), y(t)^{-1}, -y(t)^{-1}\}. \quad (5.2)$$

Each of the four relations is realized by a direct projectivity and a party permutation. In order, one may use

| relation            | projectivity                                                                      |
|---------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| $y(u) = y(t)$       | $\text{diag}(1, (1-u)/(1-t), u/t)$                                                |
| $y(u) = -y(t)$      | $\text{diag}(1, (1-u)/(1-t), -u/t)$                                               |
| $y(u) = y(t)^{-1}$  | $\begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & (u-1)/t \\ 0 & -u/(1-t) & 0 \end{pmatrix}$  |
| $y(u) = -y(t)^{-1}$ | $\begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & (1-u)/t \\ 0 & -u/(1-t) & 0 \end{pmatrix}.$ |

The corresponding permutations are respectively the identity, (56), (35)(46), and (3546). All denominators and determinants are nonzero on  $\mathcal{U}$ .

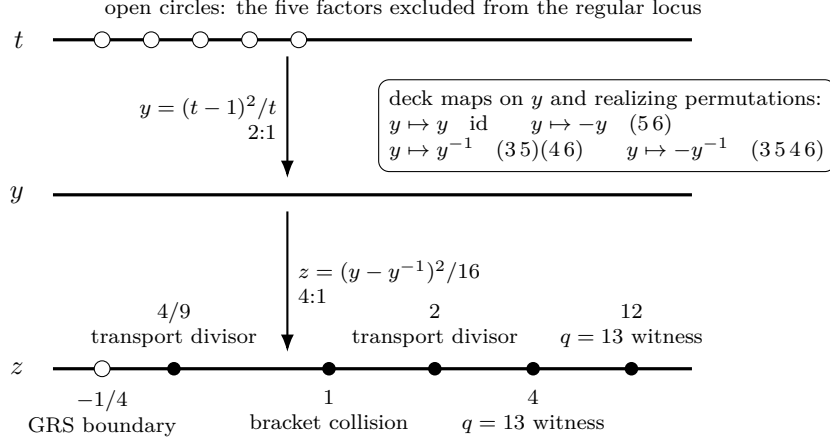


Figure 2: The degree-eight quotient of the regular non-GRS pencil (special points on the  $z$ -line are arranged schematically). The parameter  $t$  double-covers  $y = (t-1)^2/t$ , and the four identifications  $y \mapsto \pm y^{\pm 1}$ , each realized by a displayed party permutation, cover  $z$ . The open point  $z = -1/4$  is the excluded GRS boundary;  $z = 1$  is a bracket collision;  $z = 4, 12$  form the  $q = 13$  four-copy witness pair; and  $z = 2, 4/9$  belong only to the transport-rank detector, not to the LU-orbit boundary.

Conversely, the ten signed products of complementary 3-by-3 brackets of  $H_t$  form the multiset

$$\{+A, +A, +A, -A, -A, -A, +B, +B, -B, -B\}. \quad (5.3)$$

Projectivity and independent column rescaling multiply all ten products by one common scalar; party permutation changes at most their common sign. On  $\mathcal{U}$ ,  $A, B \neq 0$ . If  $A^2 \neq B^2$ , the multiplicities three and two in (5.3) distinguish the two opposite pairs and recover  $(B/A)^2 = z$ . If  $A^2 = B^2$ , the multiset instead collapses to two opposite values, each of multiplicity five. That collapsed pattern is itself invariant under the common scaling and sign, and it is equivalent to  $z = 1$ . Thus the multiset recovers  $z$  in both cases, and projective equivalence forces equality of  $z$ . The equivalence with monomial codes follows from Section 2, and projective equivalence supplies an LC equivalence.

*Recovery from minimum-support transitions.* We now specialize the imported minimum-support transition theorem to  $m = 3$ . Each four-party support identifies its two-dimensional stabilizer plane with the local Pauli-label plane at any party in that support. Overlapping supports therefore give coordinate changes between local Weyl frames, and their compositions around a loop give holonomy up to local symplectic conjugacy. These minimum-support planes generate the full stabilizer label group. The 450 quantities below are conjugacy data of these transitions, not an independent choice of scalar contractions.

For the remaining direction assume that  $q$  is prime. Then a local Clifford induces a block  $F_i \in \text{SL}_2(q)$  on each local Pauli-label plane. Put  $K_T = L_{C_t}(T)$  for every four-set  $T$ . If  $i, j \in T$ , the imported minimum-support theorem says that projection  $p_i : K_T \rightarrow \mathbb{F}_q^2$  onto the Pauli-label plane at  $i$  is an isomorphism. Define the transition

$$M_T(i, j) = p_j p_i^{-1} : (\mathbb{F}_q^2)_i \longrightarrow (\mathbb{F}_q^2)_j$$

and, for distinct four-sets  $T, U$  containing  $i, j$ , the holonomy

$$\text{Hol}(T, U; i, j) = M_U(j, i) M_T(i, j). \quad (5.4)$$

Local symplectic blocks  $F_i$  send this endomorphism to  $F_i \text{Hol } F_i^{-1}$ . Reversing  $T, U$  takes its inverse, and a party permutation only relabels the data. Thus the multiset of

$$r(M) = \text{Tr}(M)^2 / \det M$$

over the  $15 \cdot 6 \cdot 5 = 450$  choices is an LC and party-permutation invariant: it is unchanged by conjugation and scalar multiplication, and it also agrees for  $M$  and  $M^{-1}$ .

Substituting the shortened generators into (4.4), simplifying each of the 450 rational functions exactly, and collecting equal functions gives the following multiset. The paper-local certificate described in Section 7 replays both this symbolic enumeration and a separate direct-Lagrangian reconstruction:

| value of $r(M)$                           | multiplicity |       |
|-------------------------------------------|--------------|-------|
| 4                                         | 90           | (5.5) |
| $-1/z$                                    | 144          |       |
| $(2z+1)^2/z^2$                            | 24           |       |
| each root of $X^2 - 8X + (8 - 16z - 1/z)$ | 96.          |       |

Because  $A, B \neq 0$  on  $\mathcal{U}$ ,  $z \neq 0$ . The two roots are taken over an algebraic closure; their symmetric multiset descends to  $\mathbb{F}_q$ . The multiplicity 96 applies to each root before specialization; coincident values have their multiplicities added. The identity

$$4B(t)^2 + A(t)^2 = 4G(t)^2$$

shows that the excluded GRS locus is exactly  $z = -1/4$ . Away from it, the constant 4 bin is isolated and the two quadratic roots are distinct. The bin containing  $-1/z$  can merge with neither, one, or both of the weight-24 and one weight-96 contributions, so its multiplicity is 144, 168, 240, or 264. No other bin has one of these multiplicities. Hence the multiset canonically recovers  $-1/z$ , including every modular collision, and LC equivalence forces equality of  $z$ .  $\square$

The map  $t \mapsto z$  has degree eight: the four transformations in (5.2), followed by the quadratic relation  $t+t^{-1} = y+2$ , account for its eight sheets. The signed refinement  $w = B/A$ ,  $z = w^2$ , is not quantum data. Both even and odd explicit party permutations reverse  $w$ , and their projectivities lift to monomial local Cliffords.

*Proof of Corollary 5.2.* Theorem 5.1 gives all equivalences except LU. Every LC is an LU, while Theorem 1.2 turns every LU intertwiner between the states  $\Psi_t, \Psi_u$  into an LC intertwiner.  $\square$

## 5.1 Extension-field caveat

The projective quotient remains field-theoretic over odd extensions, but the prime-field LC/LU statement does not: Frobenius maps are additional local Clifford operations. The following proposition records the scalar conditions for the two Frobenius sectors without asserting a complete extension-field classification.

**Proposition 5.3** (Frobenius-sector divisors). Let  $\sigma$  be an automorphism of a finite field of odd order and let  $t \in \mathcal{U}$ . Put

$$E_\sigma(t) = (\sigma(t) - t)(1 - \sigma(t)t), \quad D_\sigma(t) = ((1 - \sigma(t))(1 - t))^2 + \sigma(t)t.$$

Then

$$\frac{\sigma(t)}{(1 - \sigma(t))^2} = \frac{t}{(1 - t)^2} \iff E_\sigma(t) = 0. \quad (5.6)$$

If  $h = (1 - \sigma(t))(1 - t)$  and  $w = (-h, -h, 1, 1, -1, -1)$ , then

$$H_{\sigma(t)} \operatorname{diag}(w) H_t^\top = 0 \iff D_\sigma(t) = 0. \quad (5.7)$$

Also  $D_{\operatorname{id}}(t) = G(t)$ , and

$$E_\sigma(t) = 0 \implies D_\sigma(t) \neq 0. \quad (5.8)$$

Finally  $G, A, B, z$  commute with  $\sigma$ , and  $\sigma$  preserves the regular non-GRS locus  $\mathcal{U}$ .

*Proof.* Membership in  $\mathcal{U}$  gives  $t \neq 1$ , and injectivity of  $\sigma$  gives  $\sigma(t) \neq 1$ . Cross multiplication in (5.6) gives

$$s(1 - t)^2 - t(1 - s)^2 = (s - t)(1 - st)$$

with  $s = \sigma(t)$ . Direct multiplication in (5.7) makes eight entries vanish identically and leaves  $-2D_\sigma(t)$  in the last entry; odd characteristic gives the equivalence. Setting  $\sigma$  to the identity yields  $D_{\operatorname{id}} = G$ .

If  $E_\sigma(t) = 0$ , then either  $\sigma(t) = t$  or  $\sigma(t)t = 1$ . In the first case  $D_\sigma(t) = G(t)$ . In the second, multiplying  $D_\sigma(t)$  by  $t^2$  gives  $G(t)$ . Membership in  $\mathcal{U}$  excludes  $t = 0$  and  $G(t) = 0$ , proving (5.8). The equivariance statements follow by applying  $\sigma$  to the defining polynomial and rational expressions.  $\square$

The prime-field hypothesis is necessary for this scalar classification. Over  $\mathbb{F}_{p^e}$ , the basis permutation  $|x\rangle \mapsto |x^p\rangle$  is a local Clifford and sends  $\Psi_t$  to  $\Psi_{t^p}$ , while  $z(t^p) = z(t)^p$  need not equal  $z(t)$ . Concretely, in  $\mathbb{F}_{25} = \mathbb{F}_5[s]/(s^2 - 2)$ , both  $s$  and  $-s = s^5$  lie in  $\mathcal{U}$ , but

$$z(s) = 3 + 3s, \quad z(-s) = 3 + 2s.$$

For each field automorphism  $\sigma$ , Proposition 5.3 gives the collision and diagonal-isodual divisors relating  $t$  to  $\sigma(t)$ . It does not show that an arbitrary additive local Clifford determines a nontrivial field automorphism, nor does it construct a local Clifford from a Galois match of  $z$ . Those two representation-theoretic bridges are not claimed here, so neither is a full extension-field LC/LU classification.

## 6 Limits of fixed-copy scalar invariants

The operator-valued marginal mechanism retains local Weyl axes. Fixed-copy scalar contractions retain less: on algebraic families they are generically constant and can distinguish parameters only on rank-jump strata. We make that limitation precise here; Appendix A records two explicit separators on exceptional strata.

For  $r$  ket copies and  $r$  bra copies, choose a permutation  $\sigma_i \in S_r$  at each party and contract ket copy  $a$  with bra copy  $\sigma_i(a)$ . If  $G$  generates a  $d$ -dimensional code, let  $M_\sigma(G)$  be the homogeneous matching system

$$(u_a G)_i = (v_{\sigma_i(a)} G)_i \quad (1 \leq i \leq n, 1 \leq a \leq r).$$

Counting its solutions gives the normalized contraction

$$I_\sigma(\Psi_C) = q^{dr - \operatorname{rank} M_\sigma(G)}. \quad (6.1)$$

**Proposition 6.1** (Generic constancy of fixed-copy invariants). Fix  $r$  and a field  $k$  of cardinality  $q$ , which is also the local Hilbert-space dimension under the code-state dictionary. Fix an irreducible reduced parameter variety  $X$  over  $k$ , and a regular generator-matrix chart  $G(x)$  of constant code dimension. Every degree- $(r, r)$  permutation contraction of the associated equal-phase states has one value at every  $k$ -point of some dense open subscheme  $U \subseteq X$  defined over

$k$ . The same holds for party-orbit sums and linear combinations. After evaluating the states as vectors in  $(\mathbb{C}^q)^{\otimes n}$ , in the stable range  $q \geq r$ , every scalar LU-invariant of bidegree  $(r, r)$  is generically constant in this sense. For a reducible family, the statement holds separately on each irreducible component.

*Proof.* Formula (6.1) depends only on the rank of a matrix whose entries are regular functions over  $k$ . A maximal nonzero minor shows that this rank is constant on a dense open subscheme defined over  $k$ . There are only finitely many diagrams at fixed  $r$ , so their generic-rank opens have a common dense intersection because  $X$  is irreducible. This proves the geometric generic-rank assertion. Over the complex vector space  $(\mathbb{C}^q)^{\otimes n}$ , applied pointwise to each code state, the first fundamental theorem for unitary invariants says that local copy-permutation diagrams span the bidegree- $(r, r)$  invariants; when the local Hilbert-space dimension  $q$  is at least  $r$ , there are no additional dimension relations among these diagrams [CS06, Section 2].  $\square$

*Remark 6.2* (Finite-field points). The dense open subscheme  $U$  need not contain a  $k$ -rational point. If  $U(k) = \emptyset$ , the corresponding pointwise statement over the finite field is vacuous; the geometric generic-rank statement remains valid.

Thus no fixed copy number can recover a nonconstant pencil coordinate on the generic locus. A scalar witness can still detect a special rank-jump stratum, as the four-copy example in Appendix A does. In contrast, the four-party reduced-operator family (2.4) retains the Weyl axes, and the imported rigidity theorem forces Cliffordness. This is the precise distinction between generic constancy of scalar invariants and the operator-valued marginal information used by the rigidity theorem.

## 7 Verification and scope

The all-length multiplier theorem and transversal-group dichotomy are proved in the text and use no finite enumeration. The only imported ingredients in the group classification are the stabilizer-AME rigidity and stabilizer-character correction stated in the introduction [Rudd26a].

The paper-local supplement contains the exact generators, compact JSON certificates, and a deterministic standard-library verifier for the six-point computations. Running

```
python3 supplement/verify.py --replay
```

checks the manifest and regenerates every certificate in memory. The supplement records each finite domain, stopping condition, independent replay, and negative scope statement.

The Lean 4 development uses toolchain v4.32.0-rc1 with a pinned Mathlib revision. Its paper-specific roots are

```
RelativeConicArcs.Gates.MDSCSSTransversalGeometry
RelativeConicArcs.Gates.MDSCSSTransversalGeometryAxioms.
```

The first is the import-only gate for the checked surface; the second prints the axiom dependencies of every cited declaration. Kernel reduction covers the MDS-CSS dictionary, multiplier nullity, pencil quotient, extension-field scalar formulas, syndrome geometry, contraction algebra, transport cycle algebra, and the abstract consequences of a supplied coordinate-permutation complement. The exact group, finite classifications, separators, and transport geometry use interfaces whose input fields are proved in the text or supplied by the certificates. Three graph cardinalities use exhaustive native evaluation; two marginal-moment results inherit the star-count evaluation axiom. Apart from those local declarations, the cited formal results use only propositional extensionality, choice, and quotient soundness.



| Claim family                            | Status                | Verification method                                              | Imported or trusted input                                                           |
|-----------------------------------------|-----------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Multiplier nullity                      | proved here           | MDS distance and a vanishing-coordinate argument                 | none                                                                                |
| Exact fixed-coordinate group            | proved here           | block preservation, explicit unipotents, and logical Paulis      | imported product-unitary rigidity and phase correction                              |
| Six-point conic criterion               | proved here           | MDS–CSS dictionary and Gale-transform argument                   | none                                                                                |
| Pencil quotient                         | proved here           | symbolic bracket identities and exact transition-map enumeration | imported minimum-support transition theorem; certificate replay for the enumeration |
| Frobenius-sector formulas               | proved here           | direct finite-field algebra                                      | no complete extension-field orbit classification                                    |
| Clebsch application                     | consequence           | syndrome lemma composed with the cited Clebsch deep-hole theorem | cited conic, count, and orbit result                                                |
| Scalar separators and transport divisor | appendix results      | exact generators, JSON certificates, and independent replay      | finite exact computation                                                            |
| Coordinate-permutation extensions       | twelve computed cases | exhaustive permutation checks and explicit complements           | no general classification beyond the listed cases                                   |
| Formalization                           | partial               | Lean kernel checking through the paper-specific gate             | hypothesis-explicit interfaces and three native finite cardinality evaluations      |

Table 1: Proof and verification status of the main claim families. A hypothesis-explicit interface proves a conclusion from named mathematical or computational inputs; importing it does not prove those inputs.

The local-unitary classification by  $z$  is restricted to odd prime fields. Over extension fields, Frobenius is already an additional local Clifford and the full additive-Clifford orbit problem is not claimed. The exact group theorem fixes the physical coordinates and assumes a product implementation. It does not classify arbitrary coordinate-permutation enlargements, non-product physical implementations, nonstabilizer AME states, or unrelated quantum-code families.

## 8 Conclusion

Diagonal isoduality turns the transversal-group problem into a one-dimensional linear test. MDS distance forces every nonzero code-to-dual diagonal multiplier to be invertible and forces all such multipliers onto one projective line. That line either constructs the elementary unipotents generating  $\mathrm{SL}_2(q)$ , or its absence leaves only the split torus. Stabilizer AME rigidity then proves that these Clifford constructions exhaust every product-unitary logical implementation.

For six coordinates, the same dichotomy becomes the conic criterion in the six-arc model. The pencil quotient, Clebsch syndrome geometry, and computed party extensions show how the all-length criterion organizes finer finite geometry without depending on those calculations. Fixed-copy scalar contractions are generically constant, whereas the operator-valued reduced states retain the local Weyl directions. This explains why the rigidity argument succeeds where bounded-degree scalar invariants do not.

Two exact questions remain. Over extension fields, the full additive Clifford group can contain nonsemilinear sectors not detected by the prime-field statement. For party-moving symmetries, the nonabelian factor set gives an exact splitting criterion, but a conceptual classification beyond the twelve computed rows is open.

## A Explicit scalar certificates

This appendix records two explicit scalar LU separators. They are not used in the rigidity or logical-group results; they show what finite-copy scalar contractions can still detect on exceptional strata despite the generic-constancy result in Section 6.

### A.1 A marginal-moment separator

For a four-party set  $T$ , let  $\rho_T$  be the reduced state and embed it into all six parties as

$$A_T = \rho_T \otimes I_{T^c}.$$

For an unordered triple  $\{T, U, V\}$  of distinct four-sets, the number  $\mathrm{Tr}(A_T A_U A_V)$  is invariant under arbitrary product unitaries; party permutation merely permutes the 455 triples. By (2.4),

$$\mathrm{Tr}(A_T A_U A_V) = q^{-\mathrm{rank}(L_C(T) + L_C(U) + L_C(V))}. \quad (\text{A.1})$$

Here and below, ranks of label spaces and matching systems are over  $\mathbb{F}_q$ . Indeed, the three stabilizer sums have total normalization  $q^{-12}$ . Only triples of labels with sum zero survive the full trace; isotropy of  $L_C$  removes multiplication phases, and the kernel of the addition map from the three two-planes has size  $q^{6-r}$ , where  $r$  is the  $\mathbb{F}_q$ -rank in (A.1).

Index a four-set by its omitted pair, an edge of  $K_6$ . The rank in (A.1) is four exactly when the three corresponding chord lines concur in both the six-arc  $\mathcal{A}$  and its Gale dual  $\mathcal{A}^*$ , represented by any kernel basis of the arc matrix. To see this, split each shortened CSS plane into its one-dimensional  $X(C)$  and  $Z(C^\perp)$  parts. For three omitted edges, the three shortened

$X$ -lines span dimension two precisely when the corresponding chords of  $\mathcal{A}^*$  concur; the  $Z$ -lines give the same criterion for  $\mathcal{A}$ . Each span has dimension at least two, so their sum has rank four exactly when both concurrences hold.

Sixty triples are stars and concur universally. Any other three-edge graph that contains two adjacent edges but is not a star has two chords meeting at their common arc point and a third chord missing it, since the columns form an arc. The only remaining graph type is a perfect matching. Hence

$$\#\{q^{-4} \text{ moments}\} = 60 + b(\mathcal{A}, \mathcal{A}^*). \quad (\text{A.2})$$

where  $b$  counts perfect matchings concurrent in both configurations.

**Lemma A.1** (Concurrent matchings on a conic). Let  $S$  be six distinct points on a nonsingular conic over a finite field  $k$  of odd characteristic other than 5. At most six perfect matchings of  $S$  have concurrent joining chords.

*Proof.* Identify the conic with  $\mathbb{P}^1$ . Projection from a point off the conic pairs the points in every fiber and hence induces a projective involution; conversely, the chords joining the three two-element orbits of a projective involution meet at its center. Thus the concurrent matchings are exactly the fixed-point-free involutions in

$$H = \text{Stab}_{\text{PGL}_2(k)}(S).$$

The correspondence is injective because an element of  $\text{PGL}_2(k)$  is determined by its action on three points. The group  $H$  acts freely on ordered triples of distinct points of  $S$ , so  $|H| \mid 6 \cdot 5 \cdot 4 = 120$ .

Dickson's classification, including the  $p$ -regular cases [Dic01, §§239–261], and Faber's  $p$ -irregular classification [Fab23, Theorem 1.1] are used only to obtain a uniform upper bound of six; no classification of the six-sets is needed. They leave the following possibilities. The last column bounds involutions having no fixed point on this six-set:

| $H$                                     | fixed-point-free involutions |
|-----------------------------------------|------------------------------|
| cyclic                                  | $\leq 1$                     |
| dihedral                                | $\leq 6$                     |
| $A_4$                                   | $\leq 3$                     |
| $S_4$                                   | $\leq 6$                     |
| $A_5$ in its faithful degree-six action | 0                            |
| $C_3$ or $S_3$ (char $k = 3$ )          | $\leq 3$ .                   |

For the  $A_5$  row, each involution fixes two of the six points. In the dihedral row, if the rotation order exceeded six, every orbit away from the two rotation-fixed points would have size at least that order, so no invariant six-set could exist; for rotation order at most six the two reflection classes together contribute at most six fixed-point-free elements (and the possible central half-turn contributes only when one reflection class has fixed points). In the characteristic-three semi-elementary case, the normal 3-group has order 3, while its cyclic complement embeds in  $\text{Aut}(C_3)$ , giving only  $C_3$  or  $S_3$ . The subfield groups whose order divides 120 are  $\text{PSL}_2(3) \cong A_4$  and  $\text{PGL}_2(3) \cong S_4$ , already listed. The remaining characteristic-five subfield possibilities are excluded by the hypothesis. Every row is therefore bounded by six.  $\square$

**Theorem A.2** (Uniform  $H_3$ /GRS separation). Let  $\tau^2 = \tau + 1$ , and let  $\mathfrak{p}$  be a prime ideal of  $\mathbb{Z}[\tau]$  of odd residue characteristic for which the reduction of the integral  $H_3$  (icosahedral sextuple

$$((0, 1, 1 - \tau), (0, 1, \tau - 1), (1, 1 - \tau, 0), (1, \tau - 1, 0), (1, 0, -\tau), (1, 0, \tau))$$

is a six-arc. Write  $k = \mathbb{Z}[\tau]/\mathfrak{p}$ . If the reduced arc is non-GRS, put  $q = |k|$ . Its equal-phase state is not LU-equivalent, even after party permutation, to any six-point GRS state over  $k$ . (The hypothesis is vacuous in characteristic five, where the reduction is itself GRS.)

*Proof.* Exact integral chord determinants give ten common concurrent matchings for the  $H_3$  arc and its Gale dual. The other five determinant norms are  $-64$  and  $-4$ , so the count is exactly ten in every residue reduction covered by the theorem. This is an exact fifteen-matching calculation in  $\mathbb{Z}[\tau]$ , not a field sample. The  $H_3$  moment multiset therefore contains 70 copies of  $q^{-4}$ .

Lemma A.1 gives at most six concurrent matchings on a conic. The bound is attained whenever  $\mathrm{PGL}_2(q)$  contains an octahedral  $S_4$ , by the corresponding six-set: the six half-turns about axes through pairs of opposite edges act without fixed vertices. Thus a GRS state has at most 66 copies of  $q^{-4}$ , and the margin  $70 > 66$  is sharp for this argument. In characteristic five no subgroup bound is needed:  $X^2 - X - 1 = (X - 3)^2$ , so the residue of  $\tau$  is 3, and direct substitution gives  $G(\tau) = 0$ . The  $H_3$  reduction is therefore GRS, contrary to the theorem's non-GRS hypothesis. Equation (A.1) is LU-invariant, so the gap proves the claim.  $\square$

The five nonconcurrent  $H_3$  matchings form a one-factorization of  $K_6$ . The marginal incidence recovers its  $S_5$  stabilizer but forgets the even  $A_5$  orientation. This is necessary: full local Fourier transform sends  $\Psi_C$  to  $\Psi_{C^\perp}$ , and an integral isoduality returns the  $H_3$  code through an odd pentad permutation in every odd reduction. The orientation is an LC-forgettable CSS electric/magnetic marking, not a separate LU class.

## A.2 The exact dimension-thirteen four-copy witness

Use the permutation contraction  $I_\sigma$  and matching system  $M_\sigma(G)$  from (6.1).

**Theorem A.3** (Exact four-copy separator at  $q = 13$ ). The two regular  $q = 13$  pencil classes with  $z = 4$  and  $z = 12$  are not local-unitary equivalent, even after arbitrary party permutation.

*Proof.* At  $q = 13$ , the regular non-GRS pencil has two classes in the same complete three-copy and marginal-moment bucket, with  $z = 4$  and  $z = 12$ . Use the explicit four-copy pattern

$$\sigma = (1, (03)(12), (23), (02)(13), (01)(23), (021)).$$

For  $\pi \in S_6$ , put  $(\pi\sigma)_i = \sigma_{\pi^{-1}(i)}$ , and sum (6.1) over all party permutations:

$$J_\sigma(\Psi) = \sum_{\pi \in S_6} I_{\pi\sigma}(\Psi).$$

Over  $\mathbb{F}_{13}$ , the  $z = 4$  class has rank 21 for all 720 terms. The  $z = 12$  class has rank 20 for 192 terms and rank 21 for 528. Therefore

$$J_\sigma(z = 4) = 720 \cdot 13^{-9}, \quad J_\sigma(z = 12) = 3024 \cdot 13^{-9}. \quad (\text{A.3})$$

This proves arbitrary-LU inequivalence directly. The complete two- and three-copy contraction sets do not separate this pair; (A.3) makes no claim that four copies are globally minimal.  $\square$

Over  $\mathbb{Q}(t)$ , every fixed four-copy matching matrix has generically constant rank, so (A.3) detects a rank-jump stratum rather than a generic orbit coordinate. Section 6 gives the general distinction between these scalar contractions and the operator-valued reduced states used in the rigidity theorem.

## B Transport calculation for the four-copy witness

We now explain the rank jump behind (A.3). Fix the six copy permutations

$$\sigma = (1, (03)(12), (23), (02)(13), (01)(23), (021)).$$

Let  $V$  be the three-dimensional message space and let  $g_i : V \rightarrow k$  be the six coordinate covectors. Form a bipartite four-sheeted cover with vertices  $L_a, R_b$ ,  $0 \leq a, b < 4$ , and a color- $i$  edge from  $L_a$  to  $R_{\sigma_i(a)}$ . Put  $V$  at each vertex and  $k$  at each edge, using  $g_{\eta(i)}$  as both restriction maps for a coordinate assignment  $\eta \in S_6$ . This is a transport system: each edge equation requires the vertex data at its two ends to agree after applying the corresponding coordinate functional. A solution is a tuple  $(x_a, y_b) \in V^8$  satisfying

$$g_{\eta(i)}(x_a - y_{\sigma_i(a)}) = 0. \quad (\text{B.1})$$

on all 24 edges. The three-dimensional constant-section space is always present. Gauging it away leaves the 24-by-21 matching matrix in (6.1).

Let  $U = k^4/k(1, 1, 1, 1)$ , and let  $\rho_i$  be the action of  $\sigma_i$  on  $U$ . For each  $\eta$ , the MDS property makes  $g_{\eta(3)}, g_{\eta(4)}, g_{\eta(5)}$  a basis of  $V^*$ . Define  $Q_\eta$  by

$$g_{\eta(i)} = \sum_{k=0}^2 (Q_\eta)_{ik} g_{\eta(3+k)} \quad (0 \leq i < 3). \quad (\text{B.2})$$

Thus  $Q_\eta$  is the left block obtained by systematizing the party-reordered generator matrix on its last three columns; no pivot can vanish because every three coordinate covectors are independent. Put  $\tilde{Q}_\eta = 2(t-1)Q_\eta$ . This scalar is a unit on the regular non-GRS locus. For the identity assignment, the polynomial representative is

$$\tilde{Q}_1 = \begin{pmatrix} a & b & c \\ a & c & b \\ d & d & d \end{pmatrix}, \quad \begin{aligned} a &= -2(t-1)^2, & b &= -(t^2 - t + 1), \\ c &= -(t^2 - 3t + 1), & d &= -2(t-1). \end{aligned}$$

If  $Y_k \in U$  are the three free copy vectors, then (B.1) reduces to the 9-by-9 block transport operator

$$\tilde{T}_\eta = ((\tilde{Q}_\eta)_{ik}(\rho_i - \rho_{3+k}))_{i,k=0}^2. \quad (\text{B.3})$$

The dimension identity

$$21 - \text{rank } M_{\pi\sigma}(G(t)) = 9 - \text{rank } \tilde{T}_\eta \quad (\text{B.4})$$

holds over the field  $k$ , where  $\eta = \pi$  in the convention of Section 6. It follows by quotienting the three-dimensional constant-section kernel and then eliminating the three free systematic coordinates. Multiplying the resulting operator by the unit  $2(t-1)$  does not change its rank. All steps are invertible on the regular non-GRS six-arc locus.

**Theorem B.1** (Transport rank-drop locus). For a parameter on the regular odd non-GRS pencil, there exists a coordinate assignment  $\eta \in S_6$  for which the transport system (B.1) has a nonconstant section if and only if

$$(B^2 - 2A^2)(9B^2 - 4A^2) = 0,$$

or equivalently

$$(z - 2)(9z - 4) = 0. \quad (\text{B.5})$$

At a generic point above  $z = 2$ , exactly 96 coordinate assignments have rank 20; at a generic point above  $z = 4/9$ , exactly 192 do. Every other assignment has rank 21.

*Proof.* For the identity systematic chart, the coefficients satisfy

$$a = b + c, \quad d^2 = -2a, \quad A = a(c - b), \quad B = bc.$$

Common copy relabelling, a change of basis in  $V$ , and rescaling a coordinate covector act on  $\tilde{T}_\eta$  by invertible row and column operations. Modulo these operations, the 720 coordinate assignments split into cases with an immediately invertible boundary block and three nonboundary cases determined by the six relative copy permutations  $\rho_j^{-1}\rho_i$ , equivalently the even-cycle pattern in each pair of colored matchings. Expanding a representative determinant by signed cycle covers gives

$$\begin{aligned} P_- &= AB(3B - 2A), \\ P_+ &= AB(3B + 2A), \\ P_2 &= A(B^2 - 2A^2). \end{aligned}$$

With integral bases the determinants are respectively

$$64d^3AB(3B - 2A), \quad 64d^3AB(3B + 2A), \quad 64d^3A(B^2 - 2A^2).$$

All omitted factors are units on the regular odd non-GRS pencil. Every assignment outside these three types has a determinant that is a unit there. The signed cycle-cover ledger, the exhaustion of the 720 assignments, and a fraction-free determinant path are recorded in the paper-local certificate. The two signed types lie above  $w = B/A = \pm 2/3$ , hence  $z = 4/9$ ; the axial type lies above  $z = 2$ . Fraction-free elimination also gives a nonzero 8-minor on each component, so the generic kernel is exactly one-dimensional.

The row/column equivalences organize the exceptional assignments into double cosets. The axial stabilizers have orders 48 and 16, with intersection of order 8, so its support has size

$$48 \cdot 16/8 = 96.$$

For either signed type the corresponding orders are 24, 48, and 6, giving

$$24 \cdot 48/6 = 192.$$

The two signed types are distinguished by the sign of  $w$ , while the axial cycle pattern differs from both; hence their support sets are disjoint. Explicit representatives, stabilizer intersections, and complete support sets are in the certificate. Equation (B.4) turns the one-dimensional transport kernels into rank 20 of the matching matrix.  $\square$

The exceptional arithmetic belongs to this detector, not to Theorem 1.2. The identity  $4B^2 + A^2 = 4G^2$  gives, respectively,

| char $k$ | specialized identities                        |
|----------|-----------------------------------------------|
| 3        | $B^2 - 2A^2 = G^2, \quad 9B^2 - 4A^2 = -A^2,$ |
| 5        | $9B^2 - 4A^2 = 4G^2,$                         |
| 7        | $9B^2 - 4A^2 = 2(B^2 - 2A^2).$                |

Thus in characteristic 3 both regular components disappear; in characteristic 5 the  $z = 4/9$  component lies on the excluded GRS boundary; and in characteristic 7 the two components merge. The disjoint 96- and 192-element supports then give the exact rank histogram: 288 assignments have rank 20, and 432 have rank 21. Characteristics 11, 13, 41 introduce only pullback ramification, with no further rank drop. These reductions and the nonzero 8-minors that control them are replayed in the certificate.

The divisor records where one scalar contraction changes rank. It is not an LU-orbit boundary and, by Proposition 6.1, cannot be promoted to a generic coordinate.

## C Computed coordinate-permutation extensions

This optional appendix records the splitting obstruction for the projective coordinate-permutation extension, together with finite examples. It may be skipped without affecting the fixed-coordinate transversal-group theorem.

### The nonabelian factor set

Let  $\Gamma$  be the fixed-coordinate projective product-unitary symmetry group,  $\tilde{\Gamma}$  allows coordinate permutations, and  $\Pi$  is the realized permutation group, so that  $1 \rightarrow \Gamma \rightarrow \tilde{\Gamma} \rightarrow \Pi \rightarrow 1$  is exact.

The extension has a section-free outer action  $\Pi \rightarrow \text{Out}(\Gamma)$ : conjugation by any lift of  $\pi \in \Pi$  gives an automorphism of  $\Gamma$ , and changing the lift changes that automorphism by an inner automorphism, because elements of the kernel act by inner automorphisms. For a normalized set-theoretic section  $s(1) = 1$ , write

$$s(\pi)s(\rho) = f_s(\pi, \rho)s(\pi\rho), \quad f_s(\pi, \rho) \in \Gamma.$$

Then  $f_s(1, \pi) = f_s(\pi, 1) = 1$ , and, with  $\alpha_\pi$  denoting conjugation by  $s(\pi)$ , associativity of three chosen lifts gives

$$f_s(\pi, \rho)f_s(\pi\rho, v) = \alpha_\pi(f_s(\rho, v))f_s(\pi, \rho v).$$

If another normalized section is  $s'(\pi) = b(\pi)s(\pi)$  with  $b(1) = 1$ , then substituting and commuting no kernel factors gives

$$f_{s'}(\pi, \rho) = b(\pi)\alpha_\pi(b(\rho))f_s(\pi, \rho)b(\pi\rho)^{-1}.$$

The order of the factors is essential because  $\Gamma$  need not be abelian. The factor set is identically one precisely when the section preserves multiplication, so the extension splits exactly when  $f_s$  can be changed to the constant identity factor set by such a normalized  $b$ . That criterion is what the computed rows below verify.

### Computed rows

**Corollary C.1** (Computed coordinate-permutation splittings). The realized projective party-permutation extension splits for both non-GRS  $q = 11$  pencil classes, the  $q = 11$  GRS evaluation-set representatives

$$\{0, 1, 2, 3, 4, 5\}, \{0, 1, 2, 3, 4, 6\}, \{0, 1, 2, 3, 5, 6\}, \{0, 1, 2, 3, 5, 9\},$$

the enhanced-symmetry  $t = -1$  rows over  $\mathbb{F}_{17}$  and  $\mathbb{F}_{31}$ , and the  $H_3$  representatives  $(q, \tau) = (11, 4), (19, 5), (29, 6), (31, 13)$ . For every listed non-GRS or  $H_3$  row, permutation parity acts on the fixed split torus  $T$  by inversion. Thus, after choosing an input coordinate and allowing coordinate permutations to compare the corresponding encoder views, a realized odd permutation enlarges the possible input symplectic blocks from  $T$  to

$$N(T) = \langle T, J \rangle, \quad J = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & -1 \\ 1 & 0 \end{pmatrix}, \quad J^2 = -I, \quad J \text{diag}(a, a^{-1})J^{-1} = \text{diag}(a^{-1}, a).$$

Hence  $N(T)/T \cong C_2$ . More precisely, the extension  $1 \rightarrow T \rightarrow N(T) \rightarrow C_2 \rightarrow 1$  inside  $\text{SL}_2(q)$  does not split in odd characteristic because every representative of the nontrivial coset has square  $-I$ ; after quotienting by scalar matrices, the corresponding projective extension splits. If the coordinate permutation fixes the input of a chosen encoder, these blocks act as an actual logical enlargement; otherwise the permutation compares two encoder views of the same six-leg tensor.

*Proof.* For each row, an exact finite computation reconstructs the fifteen four-support shortened planes, exhausts all 720 party permutations, and checks the propagated local symplectic blocks against the full CSS Lagrangian. After quotienting by the fixed-coordinate group identified in Theorem 4.2, it is enough to test input block  $I$  on the GRS locus and input blocks  $I, J$  off it; this discards no candidate. In the order in which the six  $q = 11$  rows are listed above, their permutation images are

$$S_5, \quad S_4, \quad V_4, \quad C_5, \quad S_3, \quad D_{12},$$

where  $D_{12}$  has order 12. The  $q = 17$  and  $q = 31$  enhanced rows have permutation images  $S_4$  and  $S_5$ , respectively, and each listed  $H_3$  image is  $S_5$ .

The certificate records the complete normalized factor set for each section. It also closes a complement of order  $|\Pi|$  whose projection to  $\Pi$  is bijective, and verifies that the associated normalized cochain changes the factor set to the identity. Hence every listed extension splits. Conjugating the fixed torus by the stored lifts gives the sign action; any odd lift therefore induces the nontrivial class of  $N(T)/T$ . The complement is an involution in the projective coordinate-permutation extension group; its determinant-one input block is  $J$ , whose square is  $-I$ .  $\square$

| Field and representative       | GRS | Fixed-coordinate group                  | Permutation image | Extension                    |
|--------------------------------|-----|-----------------------------------------|-------------------|------------------------------|
| $q = 11, t = 2, z = 1$         | no  | $\mathbb{F}_q^2 \rtimes T$              | $S_5$             | splits; $T \rightarrow N(T)$ |
| $q = 11, t = 10, z = 9$        | no  | $\mathbb{F}_q^2 \rtimes T$              | $S_4$             | splits; $T \rightarrow N(T)$ |
| $q = 11, \{0, 1, 2, 3, 4, 5\}$ | yes | $\mathbb{F}_q^2 \rtimes \text{SL}_2(q)$ | $V_4$             | splits                       |
| $q = 11, \{0, 1, 2, 3, 4, 6\}$ | yes | $\mathbb{F}_q^2 \rtimes \text{SL}_2(q)$ | $C_5$             | splits                       |
| $q = 11, \{0, 1, 2, 3, 5, 6\}$ | yes | $\mathbb{F}_q^2 \rtimes \text{SL}_2(q)$ | $S_3$             | splits                       |
| $q = 11, \{0, 1, 2, 3, 5, 9\}$ | yes | $\mathbb{F}_q^2 \rtimes \text{SL}_2(q)$ | $D_{12}$          | splits                       |
| $q = 17, t = -1$               | yes | $\mathbb{F}_q^2 \rtimes \text{SL}_2(q)$ | $S_4$             | splits                       |
| $q = 31, t = -1$               | no  | $\mathbb{F}_q^2 \rtimes T$              | $S_5$             | splits; $T \rightarrow N(T)$ |
| $H_3 : (q, \tau) = (11, 4)$    | no  | $\mathbb{F}_q^2 \rtimes T$              | $S_5$             | splits; $T \rightarrow N(T)$ |
| $H_3 : (q, \tau) = (19, 5)$    | no  | $\mathbb{F}_q^2 \rtimes T$              | $S_5$             | splits; $T \rightarrow N(T)$ |
| $H_3 : (q, \tau) = (29, 6)$    | no  | $\mathbb{F}_q^2 \rtimes T$              | $S_5$             | splits; $T \rightarrow N(T)$ |
| $H_3 : (q, \tau) = (31, 13)$   | no  | $\mathbb{F}_q^2 \rtimes T$              | $S_5$             | splits; $T \rightarrow N(T)$ |

Table 2: The twelve certificate-checked coordinate-permutation extensions. Here  $D_{12}$  has order 12, and  $T \rightarrow N(T)$  means that odd coordinate permutations supply the nontrivial coset of  $N(T)/T$  when encoder views are compared at a chosen input coordinate.

At  $q = 11$ , the  $t = 2, z = 1$  Clebsch/ $H_3$  class has permutation image  $S_5$ , while the  $t = 10, z = 9$  non-GRS class has permutation image  $S_4$ . Both extensions split, and odd coordinate permutations invert  $T$ . After choosing an input coordinate, the possible one-qudit projective groups across the resulting encoder views therefore form  $\mathbb{F}_q^2 \rtimes N(T)$ . This is the logical group of a fixed encoder only for the subgroup fixing its input; a general coordinate permutation compares different encoder views. The GRS fixed-coordinate logical group and this non-GRS group have orders 159720 and 2420, respectively.

Arithmetic symmetry jumps do not change which branch of the group theorem applies. The characteristic-17 tetrahedral specialization lies on the GRS locus and retains the full  $\text{SL}_2(17)$  fixed-coordinate image; its permutation image is  $S_4$ , and the computed extension splits. The characteristic-31  $A_5$  specialization is non-GRS, so its fixed-coordinate image is the split torus; its  $S_5$  permutation image also splits, and odd permutations enlarge the possible input blocks to  $N(T)$ .

## AI assistance disclosure

This project was developed with extensive assistance from OpenAI Codex and Anthropic Claude. Under the author’s direction, the systems assisted throughout with proof exploration,



literature research, symbolic and finite computation, code and formal-proof development, verification, and manuscript drafting and revision. The author checked the resulting arguments, computations, code, and cited sources, reviewed and edited all AI-assisted material, and assumes responsibility for all content.

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